



How recovery experiences shape nurses' perceptions of workplace mistreatment: A multilevel daily diary study



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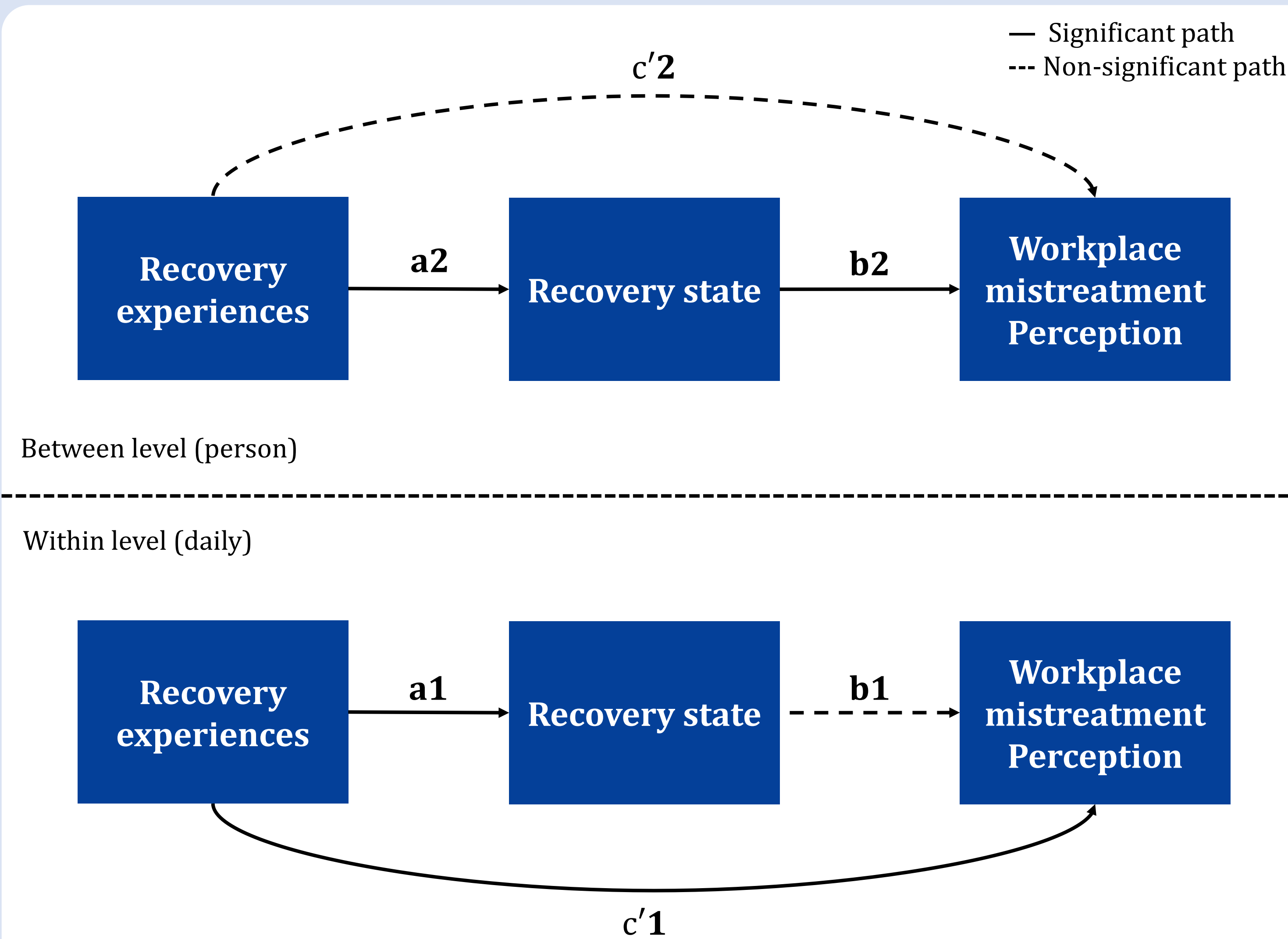


"The *accumulation of recovery* experiences builds *psychological resources* that protect nurses from *perceiving* negative workplace interactions as *mistreatment*."

01 BACKGROUND

- Workplace mistreatment is a prevalent source of employee strain; however, such behaviors are not always clear-cut and often require active interpretation.
- Employees' psychological resources can influence how they interpret workplace interactions, enabling more objective appraisal of ambiguous behaviors and less threat perception.
- However, psychological resources are finite and susceptible to depletion, making effective recovery essential for their replenishment.
- The present study tests whether recovery experiences enhance recovery state, which in turn reduces perceptions of workplace mistreatment at both the daily and person levels.

02 CONCEPTUAL MODEL



03 METHOD

- Participants**
 - 268 registered nurses employed at hospitals in South Korea.
- Procedure**
 - Using experience sampling methodology, two surveys per workday (an after-work survey and a before-work survey) were conducted over one month.
 - A total of 3,917 daily observations were obtained ($M = 14.6$ days per person).
- Measures**
 - Recovery experiences: 4 items (psychological detachment, relaxation, mastery, control)
 - Recovery state: 2 items
 - Workplace mistreatment Perception: 10 items (patients/caregivers: 4 items; supervisor: 3 items; coworker: 3 items)
- Analysis**
 - Multilevel structural equation modeling using Mplus 8.9.

04 RESULTS

- Recovery experiences significantly predicted recovery state at both the **daily** and **person** levels.
- At the **daily level**, recovery experiences directly and negatively predicted mistreatment perception, independent of recovery state. Neither the effect of recovery state nor the indirect effect was significant.
- At the **person level**, recovery state significantly and negatively predicted mistreatment perception, and the indirect effect of recovery experiences through recovery state was significant.

Path	Estimate	SE	95% CI
Within level (daily)			
Recovery experiences → Recovery state (a1)	.667***	.020	[.628, .705]
Recovery state → Mistreatment (b1)	.089	.068	[-.045, .223]
Indirect effect (a1 × b1)	.060	.046	[-.030, .149]
Recovery experiences → Mistreatment (c'1)	-.220*	.090	[-.397, -.043]
Between level (person)			
Recovery experiences → Recovery state (a2)	.870***	.064	[.745, .994]
Recovery state → Mistreatment (b2)	-1.625*	.750	[-3.094, -.156]
Indirect effect (a2 × b2)	-1.413*	.661	[-2.708, -.118]
Recovery experiences → Mistreatment (c'2)	.635	.941	[-1.209, 2.480]

Note. All estimates are unstandardized coefficients. * $p < .05$. *** $p < .001$.

05 DISCUSSION

- Recovery experience as a predictor of workplace mistreatment perception**
 - Recovery experiences predicted mistreatment perception at both levels, suggesting that how well employees recover from work extends beyond well-being outcomes to shape how they interpret interpersonal workplace events.
 - This reframes mistreatment perception as driven by a modifiable recovery state rather than fixed dispositional traits (e.g., trait NA).
- Level-dependent mechanisms linking recovery to mistreatment perception**
 - At the daily level, recovery experiences reduced mistreatment perception directly.
 - At the person level, the effect operated solely through accumulated recovery state.
 - The divergent patterns across levels call for a temporally differentiated model of how recovery shapes mistreatment perception, with daily and chronic processes operating through distinct psychological pathways.
- Future research questions**
 - Why do daily and person-level effects operate through different pathways? What mechanisms drive each?
 - Does recovery enhance perceptual accuracy, or does it merely attenuate mistreatment perception?
 - Is perceiving less mistreatment adaptive reappraisal or desensitization to genuine mistreatment?